MODULE 4

Heroic Feats

"The goal will not be reached if the right distance is not traveled."

— TIBETAN PROVERB (ANONYMOUS)

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What makes someone a hero?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Prince Charming Misplaces His Bride**	· Christopher Healy	FAIRY TALE
2	**Smokejumpers to the Rescue!**	· Laurie Toupin	NARRATIVE NONFICTION
3	**Perseus and the Fall of Medusa**	· retold by Claire Daniel	MYTH · PLAY
4	**The Battle of the Alamo**	· Amie Jane Leavitt	NARRATIVE NONFICTION

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B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 5

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 11

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 14

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 4 · Heroic Feats · Grade 4 · 27 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

fearlessness

If you show **fearlessness** in a situation, you —

- ◯ **A.** hide and hope someone else acts first.
- ◯ **B.** feel too nervous and timid to move.
- ◯ **C.** are not scared and feel brave.
- ◯ **D.** are careful to avoid any kind of danger.

Q2 L.4.6

endeavor

When you **endeavor** to do something, you —

- ◯ **A.** try very hard to do it.
- ◯ **B.** decide it is not worth the trouble.
- ◯ **C.** wait for it to happen on its own.
- ◯ **D.** finish it without any effort.

Q3 L.4.5 TRAP

confidence

If you have **confidence**, you have —

- ◯ **A.** a secret you keep from others.
- ◯ **B.** many doubts about yourself.
- ◯ **C.** a need for someone to decide for you.
- ◯ **D.** strong and sure feelings about yourself.

Q4 L.4.6

aspire

When you **aspire** to do something, you —

- ◯ **A.** are afraid to even begin it.
- ◯ **B.** have strong hopes to achieve it.
- ◯ **C.** have already given it up.
- ◯ **D.** do it only because you are told to.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · PRINCE CHARMING MISPLACES HIS BRIDE

Q5 L.4.4

elegant

Among the dozens of **elegant** women at the ball, one caught the prince's eye. Someone or something that is **elegant** is —

- ◯ **A.** stylish and graceful.
- ◯ **B.** messy and plain.
- ◯ **C.** loud and rude.
- ◯ **D.** tired and slow.

Q6 L.4.5 TRAP

foreboding

The king spoke in a **foreboding** tone. If something is described as **foreboding**, it —

- ◯ **A.** sounds cheerful and funny.
- ◯ **B.** shows that someone is bored.
- ◯ **C.** suggests that something bad is going to happen.
- ◯ **D.** means that good news is coming.

Q7 L.4.4

episode

That tiger **episode** had really frightened Frederic. An **episode** is —

- ◯ **A.** a habit you repeat every single day.
- ◯ **B.** an event or period of time that is important in some way.
- ◯ **C.** a plan for something that has not happened yet.
- ◯ **D.** a rule that everyone must follow.

Q8 L.4.5 TRAP

scowled

"You don't get it at all," the king **scowled**. If you **scowled**, you —

- ◯ **A.** smiled with delight.
- ◯ **B.** laughed out loud.
- ◯ **C.** sang a happy song.
- ◯ **D.** frowned or had an angry look on your face.

Q9 L.4.5 TRAP

intimidated

Frederic was utterly **intimidated** by the thought of leaving the palace. Someone who is **intimidated** —

- ◯ **A.** feels afraid of someone or something.
- ◯ **B.** feels brave and ready for anything.
- ◯ **C.** feels proud and pleased.
- ◯ **D.** feels calm and relaxed.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · PRINCE CHARMING MISPLACES HIS BRIDE (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.4.4

subdued

After the king's warning, Frederic's mood was **subdued**. Something that is **subdued** is —

- ◯ **A.** loud and full of energy.
- ◯ **B.** bright and cheerful.
- ◯ **C.** not strong, loud, or intense.
- ◯ **D.** sudden and surprising.

Q11 L.4.4

disheveled

After years of cleaning, Ella looked **disheveled**. If something is **disheveled**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** neat and well groomed.
- ◯ **B.** not neat or tidy.
- ◯ **C.** clean and freshly pressed.
- ◯ **D.** plain but perfectly arranged.

Q12 L.4.5 TRAP

rigid

At first, Reginald held a **rigid** posture. Something that is **rigid** is —

- ◯ **A.** soft and floppy.
- ◯ **B.** warm and gentle.
- ◯ **C.** light and floating.
- ◯ **D.** stiff and does not bend easily.

Q13 L.4.4

feisty

Frederic could use someone as **feisty** as Ella in his life. Someone who is **feisty** is —

- ◯ **A.** bold, energetic, and determined.
- ◯ **B.** quiet, shy, and still.
- ◯ **C.** sleepy and slow to move.
- ◯ **D.** careful never to speak up.

Q14 L.4.4

sulked

"I'm pretty lousy at being a hero," Frederic **sulked**. If you **sulked**, you —

- ◯ **A.** cheered up and felt glad.
- ◯ **B.** talked happily about your feelings.
- ◯ **C.** were upset about something and refused to talk about it.
- ◯ **D.** calmly agreed with what was said.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · SMOKEJUMPERS TO THE RESCUE!

Q15 L.4.5 TRAP

timid

A smokejumper cannot be **timid** about jumping from a plane. Someone who is **timid** is —

- ◯ **A.** bold and eager to take risks.
- ◯ **B.** shy and may lack courage or confidence.
- ◯ **C.** strong and very fast.
- ◯ **D.** friendly and talkative.

Q16 L.4.4

strenuous

Smokejumpers go through weeks of **strenuous** training. If an activity is **strenuous**, it —

- ◯ **A.** is quick and easy.
- ◯ **B.** can be done while resting.
- ◯ **C.** takes no effort at all.
- ◯ **D.** takes great effort or a lot of energy.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · PERSEUS AND THE FALL OF MEDUSA

Q17 L.4.4

devised

Polydectes had **devised** a plan to marry Danae. If you **devised** a plan, you —

- ◯ **A.** figured out a way to achieve it.
- ◯ **B.** gave up on it before starting.
- ◯ **C.** copied it exactly from someone else.
- ◯ **D.** ruined it by accident.

Q18 L.4.5 TRAP

distress

"Perseus, no!" cried Danae in **distress**. If you are in **distress**, you are —

- ◯ **A.** calm and content.
- ◯ **B.** very worried and upset.
- ◯ **C.** sleepy and bored.
- ◯ **D.** proud and joyful.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · PERSEUS AND THE FALL OF MEDUSA (CONTINUED)

Q19 L.4.4

odyssey

Danae feared that the **odyssey** would mean certain death. An **odyssey** is —

- ◯ **A.** a short, easy walk close to home.
- ◯ **B.** a quick trip that is over in minutes.
- ◯ **C.** a long journey that is exciting and eventful.
- ◯ **D.** a rest taken in the middle of a trip.

Q20 L.4.4

destiny

"If **destiny** calls me to die, so be it," said Perseus. A person's **destiny** is —

- ◯ **A.** a choice they can easily change at any time.
- ◯ **B.** a memory of something already finished.
- ◯ **C.** a wish that is sure never to come true.
- ◯ **D.** what will eventually happen in his or her life.

Q21 L.4.5 TRAP

mortal

Medusa's looks were deadly to Perseus and any other **mortal**. A **mortal** is —

- ◯ **A.** a person who lives and dies.
- ◯ **B.** a god who lives forever.
- ◯ **C.** a being that can never be harmed.
- ◯ **D.** a spirit that has no body at all.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE BATTLE OF THE ALAMO

Q22 L.4.4

surrendered

After four days of battle, the Mexican leader, General Martin Perfecto de Cos, has **surrendered**. If you **surrendered** to an enemy, you —

- ◯ **A.** kept on fighting until the other side ran away.
- ◯ **B.** gave up and agreed that the other side won.
- ◯ **C.** made a secret plan to attack again later.
- ◯ **D.** sent for more soldiers to come and help you.

Q23 L.4.4

rebellion

Some Texian leaders were so angry that they started a **rebellion**. In a **rebellion**, people —

- ◯ **A.** agree to follow their leaders and keep every law the same.
- ◯ **B.** leave their homes quietly and move to a faraway land.
- ◯ **C.** defy authority and fight for change in their political system.
- ◯ **D.** gather to celebrate their government with music and food.

Q24 L.4.4

furious

News of the rebellion in Texas made it back to Mexico City. Santa Anna was **furious**. Someone who is **furious** is —

- ◯ **A.** calm and not bothered at all.
- ◯ **B.** only a little bit surprised.
- ◯ **C.** very happy and proud.
- ◯ **D.** very, very angry.

Q25 L.4.4

tyrant

Travis says, "We'll never surrender to that **tyrant**!" A **tyrant** is —

- ◯ **A.** a powerful person who rules others in a cruel or unreasonable way.
- ◯ **B.** a leader who is chosen by a fair vote of all the people.
- ◯ **C.** a soldier who guards the gates of a city through the night.
- ◯ **D.** a rider who carries letters and messages between towns.

Q26 L.4.4

occasionally

Travis orders the cannon crew to fire only **occasionally**. If you do something **occasionally**, you do it —

- ◯ **A.** every single minute without stopping.
- ◯ **B.** only once in a while.
- ◯ **C.** never, not even one time.
- ◯ **D.** all at once in one big burst.

Q27 L.4.4

secure

On the afternoon of March 5, you return to help Jameson **secure** the north wall. When you **secure** an area, you —

- ◯ **A.** leave it open so anyone can walk in.
- ◯ **B.** tear it down to build something new.
- ◯ **C.** make it safe from being attacked.
- ◯ **D.** paint it so that it looks nicer.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 4 · Heroic Feats · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3 · RL.4.5 · RL.4.6 · RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3 · RI.4.5 · RI.4.6 · RI.4.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Prince Charming Misplaces His Bride

FAIRY TALE · CHRISTOPHER HEALY · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.4.2

What is "Prince Charming Misplaces His Bride" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A king who learns how to tame a wild tiger.
- ◯ **B.** A bard who writes the most famous song in the land.
- ◯ **C.** A fearful prince who must find his courage to go after Ella, the adventurous girl he loves.
- ◯ **D.** A groom who teaches everyone in the palace to ride horses.

Q2 RL.4.3

Why is Prince Frederic so fearful at the start of the story?

- ◯ **A.** His father, King Wilberforce, has shielded him from anything that might cause him harm.
- ◯ **B.** He was once lost at sea during a great storm.
- ◯ **C.** He has never been allowed to eat at the palace.
- ◯ **D.** He lost a race to another prince when he was young.

Q3 RL.4.3

What does Frederic learn about Ella that surprises him?

- ◯ **A.** She is a princess from a neighboring kingdom.
- ◯ **B.** She is a sooty cleaning girl who escaped her wicked stepfamily and dreams of adventure.
- ◯ **C.** She cannot dance and has never been to a ball.
- ◯ **D.** She is the daughter of the royal bard.

Q4 RL.4.3

Why does Frederic stand up to his father for the first time?

- **A.** The king will not let him train a tiger.
- **B.** The king forgot his birthday.
- **C.** The king wants him to leave the palace at once.
- **D.** The king calls Ella an "ill-bred wife," and Frederic decides his heart still wants Ella.

Q5 RL.4.3

How does Frederic respond to most of Ella's ideas for adventure, such as tumbling with acrobats or boating on the lake?

- **A.** He makes up excuses to avoid them, even ones that are not really true.
- **B.** He happily agrees to every single one.
- **C.** He invents braver adventures of his own.
- **D.** He asks the king to come along with them.

Q6 RL.4.6

The story is told by a narrator who can share what different characters think and feel. How does this point of view help the reader?

- **A.** It hides the difference between Frederic's excuses and the truth.
- **B.** It lets the reader see the gap between Frederic's excuses and what is really true, and what others feel.
- **C.** It tells the story only from Ella's point of view.
- **D.** It keeps all of the characters' feelings a secret.

Q7 RL.4.3

What finally convinces Frederic to set out and go after Ella?

- **A.** The king orders him to leave.
- **B.** Charles promises to ride along beside him.
- **C.** Reginald urges him to find his courage and reminds him of what his mother would want.
- **D.** Pennyfeather writes him a new song.

Q8 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "Prince Charming Misplaces His Bride"?

- **A.** A wise ruler should always decide what is safest for his grown children.
- **B.** Looking fashionable matters more than learning any new skill.
- **C.** It is wiser to stay safe at home than to risk a real adventure.
- **D.** Do not let your fears control your life; find your own courage and go after what you truly want.

Selection 2 · Smokejumpers to the Rescue!

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · LAURIE TOUPIN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.4.2

What is "Smokejumpers to the Rescue!" mainly about?

- **A.** Specially trained firefighters who parachute in to fight wildfires, and how they train and work.
- **B.** How pilots learn to fly the planes that carry the jumpers.
- **C.** Why wildfires start in dry forests each summer.
- **D.** How families can stay safe during a forest fire.

Q10 RI.4.3

According to the text, what is a smokejumper's most important task at a wildfire?

- **A.** To take photographs of the flames.
- **B.** To create a firebreak, a stretch of ground with nothing left to burn.
- **C.** To pour water on the fire from the plane.
- **D.** To wait on the ground until the fire stops on its own.

Q11 RI.4.3

After the twenty jumpers land safely, what does the plane drop to them?

- **A.** Extra parachutes for the trip home.
- **B.** New uniforms and boots.
- **C.** Boxes with chain saws, shovels, Pulaskis, first-aid kits, food, and water.
- **D.** Maps of the nearest town.

Q12 RI.4.3

Why do smokejumpers parachute in instead of reaching a fire from the ground?

- **A.** They are not allowed to drive fire trucks.
- **B.** They enjoy the view from the airplane.
- **C.** There are no roads anywhere in the country.
- **D.** Airplanes are much faster, so the closest jumpers can reach a far-off fire within about thirty-five minutes.

Q13 RI.4.3

What does the "Practice, Practice, Practice!" sidebar tell readers about becoming a smokejumper?

- ◯ **A.** Anyone can become one in a single afternoon.
- ◯ **B.** Would-be jumpers must pass a fitness test and complete weeks of hard training, including packing their own parachutes.
- ◯ **C.** Smokejumpers never have to exercise.
- ◯ **D.** Packing a parachute takes only a few seconds.

Q14 RI.4.6

The author includes quotations from smokejumper Patrick Withen. How does hearing his firsthand words help the reader?

- ◯ **A.** It proves that fighting fires is never dangerous.
- ◯ **B.** It tells the reader how to become a pilot.
- ◯ **C.** It lets the reader understand the work from someone who has really done it.
- ◯ **D.** It hides the facts about how smokejumpers train.

Q15 RI.4.5

This selection uses captioned photographs and a "Practice, Practice, Practice!" sidebar. How do these text features help the reader?

- ◯ **A.** They turn the article into a made-up story.
- ◯ **B.** They list the price of each tool.
- ◯ **C.** They hide the most important facts.
- ◯ **D.** They show the work in action and add facts about how smokejumpers train.

Q16 RI.4.8 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea the author wants readers to understand in "Smokejumpers to the Rescue!"?

- ◯ **A.** Packing a parachute is the hardest part of a smokejumper's whole job.
- ◯ **B.** Smokejumpers are brave, highly trained firefighters who risk themselves to save lives and land.
- ◯ **C.** Airplanes are a more exciting way to travel than fire trucks are.
- ◯ **D.** Fighting wildfires from the ground is always safer than jumping in.

Selection 3 · Perseus and the Fall of Medusa

MYTH · PLAY · RETOLD BY CLAIRE DANIEL · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.4.2

What is the play "Perseus and the Fall of Medusa" mostly about?

- **A.** A hero who is tricked into a deadly quest, slays Medusa, and saves both a princess and his mother.
- **B.** A king who builds the largest palace in Greece.
- **C.** A group of gods who hold a feast on a mountain.
- **D.** A sailor who gets lost on the open sea.

Q18 RL.4.3

Why does Polydectes send Perseus to bring back the head of Medusa?

- **A.** He wants Perseus to become a famous hero.
- **B.** He needs the head to decorate his palace.
- **C.** He has devised a trap to get Perseus out of the way so he can marry Perseus's mother, Danae.
- **D.** He wants to test which guest brought the best gift.

Q19 RL.4.3

How do the gods help Perseus on his quest?

- **A.** Zeus gives a sword, Athena gives a mirror-shield and a knapsack, and Hermes gives winged slippers.
- **B.** They tell him to give up and go home.
- **C.** They fight the sea monster for him.
- **D.** They hide Medusa so he cannot find her.

Q20 RL.4.3

How does Perseus rescue Andromeda?

- **A.** He pays the sea monster to leave her alone.
- **B.** He teaches her to swim away.
- **C.** He asks Polydectes to free her.
- **D.** He turns the sea monster to stone with Medusa's head, then cuts the chain to free her.

Q21 RL.4.5

"Perseus and the Fall of Medusa" is written as a play. Which feature shows that it is a play rather than a regular story?

- **A.** It is divided into chapters with page numbers.
- **B.** It has a cast of characters, scene headings, and stage directions in italics within parentheses.
- **C.** It uses headings, charts, and captions.
- **D.** It is written as a list of facts.

Q22 RL.4.6

What is the role of the Narrator in the play?

- **A.** The Narrator battles Medusa in place of Perseus.
- **B.** The Narrator is the king's chief advisor.
- **C.** The Narrator sets the scene and explains the action between scenes.
- **D.** The Narrator only announces the ending.

Q23 RL.4.3

What happens to Polydectes at the end of the play?

- **A.** He apologizes and sets Danae free himself.
- **B.** He sails away to a new kingdom.
- **C.** He becomes Perseus's friend.
- **D.** He and his court are turned to stone when Perseus reveals Medusa's head.

Q24 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "Perseus and the Fall of Medusa"?

- **A.** True heroism is shown through bravery and using one's gifts to protect others and right wrongs.
- **B.** A clever ruler can win whatever he wants by setting traps for others.
- **C.** A true hero should win every battle completely on his own.
- **D.** Powerful magical gifts matter more than the courage to use them.

Selection 4 · The Battle of the Alamo

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · AMIE JANE LEAVITT · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RI.4.2

What is "The Battle of the Alamo" mainly about?

- **A.** How church leaders called missionaries lived in the Alamo about 100 years earlier.
- **B.** How the Texians fought to break free of Mexico, lost the Alamo, and won Texas's freedom.
- **C.** The plaza, cattle pen, courtyards, and chapel shown on the diagram of the Alamo.
- **D.** The trip that Davy Crockett and his group made from Tennessee into San Antonio.

Q26 RI.4.3

According to the text, why did some Texian leaders start a rebellion against Mexico?

- **A.** Mexico had refused to let settlers from the United States buy land in Texas.
- **B.** Spain's professionally trained army was trying to take Texas back from Mexico.
- **C.** Santa Anna's harsher laws gave citizens fewer rights, and they worried about losing more.
- **D.** The Mexican Army had burned down the shacks and homes of San Antonio.

Q27 RI.4.3

Why does Travis order the cannon crew to fire only occasionally?

- **A.** The cannons are broken, so they can only be fired a few times in all.
- **B.** He hopes Santa Anna's army will grow tired and march back to Mexico.
- **C.** He does not want to harm the townspeople still inside San Fernando Church.
- **D.** The cannonballs can't be wasted this early, since they will be needed later.

Q28 RI.4.3

What happens after Travis draws a line in the sand at the meeting in the plaza?

- **A.** Almost everyone crosses to stay and fight, but "you" and Louis Rose choose to leave.
- **B.** Everyone agrees to sneak out of the Alamo together later that same night.
- **C.** Travis announces that he will surrender the Alamo to Santa Anna the next day.
- **D.** The defenders choose John Smith to lead them in place of William Travis.

Q29 RI.4.6

In paragraphs 9–48, the author writes, "You were born in Louisiana," and uses the words *you* and *your*. Why does she use this second-person point of view?

- **A.** To prove that the author herself was one of the defenders inside the Alamo.
- **B.** To draw the reader in, as if the reader were a Texian settler living through it.
- **C.** To tell the events only the way Santa Anna saw them from Mexico City.
- **D.** To give the reader a long list of dates to memorize for a test.

Q30 RI.4.5

The selection is divided by headings ("Taking Sides Over Texas," "Fighting for Texas," "Remember the Alamo!") and tells events in chronological order. How do these features help the reader?

- **A.** They show that the events in the selection are made up, like a fairy tale.
- **B.** They list how much each supply from La Villita cost the defenders.
- **C.** They tell what each section is about and keep the events in time order.
- **D.** They mix up the events so the reader has to guess what came first.

Q31 RI.4.3

On April 21, what happens when Houston's army meets Santa Anna and his men near San Jacinto?

- **A.** Santa Anna's army wins once again, and Houston becomes Santa Anna's prisoner.
- **B.** Houston's army surrenders to Santa Anna in order to save the town of Gonzales.
- **C.** The battle goes on for many weeks, and in the end neither side wins.
- **D.** Houston catches Santa Anna by surprise, and the Texians win in 18 minutes.

Q32 RI.4.8 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea the author wants readers to understand in "The Battle of the Alamo"?

- **A.** Losing the Alamo did not end the fight; its memory helped Texas win its freedom.
- **B.** Once the Alamo was lost, the Texians gave up their fight for independence for good.
- **C.** The defenders won the Alamo because they had more men and more cannons than Santa Anna.
- **D.** Anyone who chose to leave the Alamo lost the respect of all the others inside.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 4 · Heroic Feats · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about what makes someone a hero. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Change DOK 3

In **"Prince Charming Misplaces His Bride,"** Frederic changes from a fearful prince into someone willing to set out into the world. Show how he feels at the START, then explain WHAT makes him change.

A HERO CHANGES · PRINCE CHARMING

FREDERIC AT THE START	WHAT PUSHES HIM	FREDERIC BY THE END

Reginald tells Frederic, "There's a bit of courage in you somewhere. Find it." What does this show about becoming a hero? Use the word *change* in your answer.

Q2 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Smokejumpers to the Rescue!,"** smokejumpers take responsibility for protecting people and land. Show the PROBLEM they face, then explain WHAT it takes to do their job.

TAKING RESPONSIBILITY · SMOKEJUMPERS

THE PROBLEM	WHAT THEY DO	WHAT IT TAKES
what danger do they respond to?	*how do they fight the fire?*	*training, courage, teamwork?*

Why is taking responsibility for others part of what makes the smokejumpers heroes? Explain.

Q3 Connection DOK 3

In **"Perseus and the Fall of Medusa,"** Perseus does not succeed alone. Show how OTHERS help him, then explain how he uses their help to act like a hero.

HEROES AND THEIR HELPERS · PERSEUS

WHO HELPS PERSEUS	WHOM PERSEUS HELPS

Perseus rescues Andromeda and saves his mother. What does this show about how a hero uses gifts and help from others? Explain.

Q4 Perseverance DOK 3

In **"The Battle of the Alamo,"** the Texians do not give up, even after they lose the Alamo. Compare what happens at the Alamo at FIRST with what happens in the END.

NEVER GIVING UP · THE ALAMO

AT FIRST	IN THE END

Texans still "remember the brave defenders of the Alamo." How does their perseverance make them heroes? Explain.

Q5 Responsibility DOK 4

Essential Question: What makes someone a hero? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

Who acts like a hero here, and what makes them one?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

Who acts like a hero here, and what makes them one?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 4 · Heroic Feats · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Lifeguard's Whistle

Nina loved swimming more than anything, so when she turned fifteen she trained to become a lifeguard at the town pool. The training was harder than she expected. She had to swim many laps without stopping, learn how to pull a person safely to the side, and practice giving help until she could do it without thinking. Some mornings her arms ached and she wanted to quit. But she remembered why she wanted the job: to keep other people safe. One hot afternoon, while Nina sat in the tall lifeguard chair, she saw a small boy slip under the water near the deep end. In an instant she blew her whistle, dove in, and brought him safely to the edge. The boy coughed and then began to cry, but he was all right. His mother hugged Nina and thanked her again and again. That night Nina felt tired but proud. All those hard hours of practice had been worth it. A hero, she realized, is not always someone famous. Sometimes a hero is simply a person who is ready to help when it matters most.

185 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1 RIT 200 Lexile 500L Key Detail

Why did Nina train to become a lifeguard?

- ◯ **A.** She wanted to win a swimming race.
- ◯ **B.** Her teacher made her do it.
- ◯ **C.** She loved swimming and wanted to keep other people safe.
- ◯ **D.** She wanted to become famous on television.

Q2 RIT 202 Lexile 520L Key Detail

What did Nina have to do during her training?

- ◯ **A.** Swim many laps and learn how to pull a person safely to the side.
- ◯ **B.** Memorize the names of every swimmer at the pool.
- ◯ **C.** Clean the pool before it opened each morning.
- ◯ **D.** Win a race against the other lifeguards.

Q3 RIT 203 | Lexile 530L | Cause & Effect

Why did Nina sometimes want to quit during training?

- ◯ **A.** The water was too cold.
- ◯ **B.** She did not like the other swimmers.
- ◯ **C.** She was bored by the easy lessons.
- ◯ **D.** Her arms ached and the training was hard.

Q4 RIT 205 | Lexile 550L | Inference

When Nina blew her whistle, dove in, and brought the boy to the edge, this shows that she —

- ◯ **A.** had forgotten her training.
- ◯ **B.** was ready to act quickly because she had practiced so hard.
- ◯ **C.** was afraid to get into the water.
- ◯ **D.** wanted someone else to act first.

Q5 RIT 206 | Lexile 560L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Lifeguard's Whistle"?

- ◯ **A.** You should only take a job that turns out to be easy.
- ◯ **B.** A real hero must be famous for people to notice.
- ◯ **C.** Learning to swim is the most important skill of all.
- ◯ **D.** A hero can be an ordinary person who is ready to help when it matters most.

Passage 2 · The Search-and-Rescue Dogs

When an earthquake or a storm knocks down buildings, people can become trapped beneath the rubble. Finding them quickly is hard work, because rescuers cannot see through broken concrete and twisted metal. This is where search-and-rescue dogs become heroes. These special dogs are trained for many months to use their powerful sense of smell. A dog's nose is thousands of times stronger than a human nose, so a trained dog can catch the scent of a person buried deep below. When the dog smells someone, it barks or sits down to signal its handler, the person who works with it. Then rescue workers know exactly where to dig. The dogs must be brave and calm. They climb over shaky piles of rubble and crawl into narrow spaces that would frighten most animals. They also have to ignore loud noises and strange smells so they can stay focused on their task. Thanks to these hardworking dogs and the people who train them, many lives have been saved after disasters. A search-and-rescue dog shows that a hero does not have to be human at all.

183 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Key Detail

Why is it hard to find people trapped after a building falls?

- **A.** Rescuers cannot see through broken concrete and twisted metal.
- **B.** The trapped people keep moving from place to place.
- **C.** The rubble is too hot for anyone to touch.
- **D.** Rescue dogs are afraid of fallen buildings.

Q7 RIT 208 · Lexile 580L · Key Detail

What makes a dog able to find a person buried deep below the rubble?

- **A.** Its sharp eyesight in the dark.
- **B.** Its powerful sense of smell, far stronger than a human nose.
- **C.** Its ability to dig faster than people.
- **D.** Its very loud bark.

Q8 RIT 209 · Lexile 590L · Cause & Effect

What happens after a dog smells a trapped person and signals its handler?

- **A.** The dog runs home to rest.
- **B.** The rescue is called off for the day.
- **C.** Rescue workers know exactly where to dig.
- **D.** The dog digs the person out by itself.

Q9 RIT 210 · Lexile 600L · Inference

Why does the passage say the dogs must be "brave and calm"?

- **A.** They get to rest whenever the work feels too scary.
- **B.** They are afraid of their handlers.
- **C.** Staying calm helps them dig faster than the workers.
- **D.** They must climb over shaky rubble and ignore scary noises to stay focused on their task.

Q10 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Search-and-Rescue Dogs"?

- **A.** Trained rescue dogs are heroes who use their skills and courage to help save lives.
- **B.** A hero has to be a person and never an animal.
- **C.** Machines can find trapped people better than dogs can.
- **D.** The most important thing a dog learns is how to bark loudly.

Passage 3 · Harriet Tubman, Conductor of Freedom

Harriet Tubman was born into slavery in the United States almost two hundred years ago. As a young woman, she made a daring escape to the North, where she would finally be free. But Harriet did not stop there. She knew that her family and many others were still trapped in slavery, so she made a brave decision: she would go back to help them escape, too. Over the next ten years, Harriet returned to the South again and again. She became a famous "conductor" on the Underground Railroad, a secret network of people and safe houses that guided enslaved people to freedom. The work was extremely dangerous. If she had been caught, she could have lost her own freedom or her life. Yet Harriet traveled at night, used clever signals, and never lost a single person she was leading. People said she was fearless. By the time the work was done, she had guided dozens of people out of slavery. Harriet Tubman is remembered as a hero because she risked everything, not for herself, but to give others the freedom she believed everyone deserved.

185 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 211–216

Q11 RIT 211 Lexile 620L Key Detail

After Harriet Tubman escaped to the North, what brave decision did she make?

- ◯ **A.** To stay in one place and never travel again.
- ◯ **B.** To go back to the South to help her family and others escape, too.
- ◯ **C.** To write a book about her life.
- ◯ **D.** To become a teacher in a school.

Q12 RIT 212 Lexile 640L Key Detail

What was the Underground Railroad?

- ◯ **A.** A real train that ran beneath the ground.
- ◯ **B.** A road built only for wagons.
- ◯ **C.** A school for young conductors.
- ◯ **D.** A secret network of people and safe houses that guided enslaved people to freedom.

Q13 RIT 213 Lexile 660L Cause & Effect

Why was Harriet Tubman's work so dangerous?

- ◯ **A.** The trips were very long and boring.
- ◯ **B.** She did not know the way north.
- ◯ **C.** If she had been caught, she could have lost her own freedom or her life.
- ◯ **D.** She was afraid of traveling at night.

Q14 RIT 215 Lexile 680L Vocabulary

The passage says people called Harriet "fearless." In this passage, **fearless** means —

- ◯ **A.** brave and not afraid, even in danger.
- ◯ **B.** unsure about what to do next.
- ◯ **C.** tired and ready to give up.
- ◯ **D.** careful never to leave home.

Q15 RIT 216 Lexile 700L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Harriet Tubman, Conductor of Freedom"?

- ◯ **A.** Once you reach safety, it is best to think only of yourself.
- ◯ **B.** A hero risks everything for others, not just for herself.
- ◯ **C.** A hero should take risks only when there is no danger at all.
- ◯ **D.** Escaping once is enough to make a person a hero.

Passage 4 · The Quiet Hero of Room 12

Everyone at Maple Street School knew that Theo was the smallest kid in the fourth grade, and some of the older students teased him for it. So no one expected Theo to be the one who stood up for Sam. Sam was new that year, and he walked with a limp because of an old injury. One rainy morning, a group of boys began to mock the way Sam walked, laughing as he tried to hurry past them. Theo felt his heart pound. He knew that saying something might turn the teasing on him instead. For a moment he wanted to look away, the way the other students did. But he thought about how lonely and scared Sam must feel. Theo took a deep breath and stepped between Sam and the boys. "Leave him alone," he said, his voice shaking but clear. "He hasn't done anything to you." The boys were so surprised that they stopped and walked off. Sam gave Theo a grateful smile, and the two became good friends. Being a hero, Theo learned, does not always mean being the biggest or the strongest. Sometimes it means having the courage to do the right thing when it would be easier to stay silent.

205 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16 RIT 216 Lexile 700L Key Detail

Why did some older students tease Theo?

- ◯ **A.** He always got the best grades.
- ◯ **B.** He was new at the school that year.
- ◯ **C.** He was the smallest kid in the fourth grade.
- ◯ **D.** He walked with a limp.

Q17 RIT 217 Lexile 720L Cause & Effect

Why did Theo almost want to look away instead of helping Sam?

- ◯ **A.** He did not like Sam.
- ◯ **B.** He thought a teacher was already coming to help.
- ◯ **C.** He was late for class.
- ◯ **D.** He knew that speaking up might turn the teasing on him instead.

Q18 RIT 218 Lexile 740L Key Detail

What did Theo do when the boys mocked Sam?

- **A.** He stepped between Sam and the boys and told them to leave Sam alone.
- **B.** He laughed along with the boys.
- **C.** He ran to tell the teacher.
- **D.** He pretended he did not see anything.

Q19 RIT 219 Lexile 770L Inference

Why does the passage say Theo's voice was "shaking but clear"?

- **A.** Because he was cold from the rain.
- **B.** Because he was scared, but he spoke up bravely anyway.
- **C.** Because he had a sore throat.
- **D.** Because he was not really worried at all.

Q20 RIT 220 Lexile 800L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Quiet Hero of Room 12"?

- **A.** Only the biggest and strongest person can be a hero.
- **B.** It is wise to stay silent so the teasing does not turn on you.
- **C.** A hero is someone with the courage to do the right thing, even when it is hard.
- **D.** The best way to make a friend is to win a fight.